Sedimentary Rocks



The formation of sedimentary rocks varies so there are a variety of sedimentary rocks. All of these rocks require a very long time for the processes of weathering, erosion, deposition, compaction and cementation to occur. These processes can take millions of years.

Three types of sedimentary rocks are formed when weathered rock particles, organisms die or precipitated particles are compacted and cemented together. These three types of rocks are referred to as clastic sedimentary rock, organic sedimentary rock and chemical sedimentary rock, respectively.

Clastic sedimentary rocks consist of smaller rocks cemented together. Examples include **conglomerate** and **brecchia**.

Organic sedimentary rock is formed when organisms die and layers form that are eventually covered by clastic sedimentary rock and compressed. Examples include **coal** and **limestone**.

Chemical sedimentary rocks form as a result of a chemical reaction that produces a precipitation. **Banded iron formations (BIF)** are chemical sedimentary rocks that contain iron oxide layers and are usually composed of the minerals magnetite and hematite.

Give the meaning of the following words in the paragraphs above:

1. Formation _____

2. Weathering _____

3. Erosion _____

4. Deposition _____

5. Compaction _____

6. Cementation _____

7. Organic _____

8. Precipitated _____





Which words or phrases in the text can be replaced with the following:

1. Differs _____

2. Need _____

3. Squashing together _____

4. Gluing together _____

5. Created _____

6. Called _____

7. In the end _____

8. Have _____



Questions

1. What processes need to happen for a sedimentary rock to form? _____

   _____

2. How long can a sedimentary rock take to form? _____

   _____

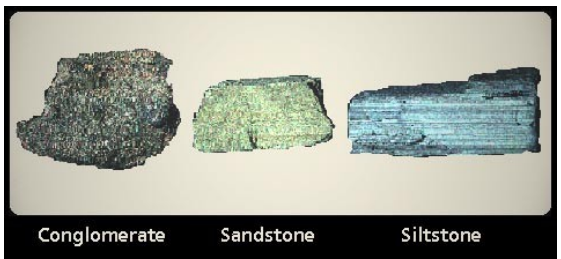
3. What are the three sedimentary rocks? _____

   _____

4. What are clastic rocks made of? _____

   _____

5. Name a clastic sedimentary rock _____



6. What are organic sedimentary rocks made of? _____

_____

7. Name an organic sedimentary rock _____

8. How do chemical sedimentary rocks form? _____

_____

9. Name a chemical sedimentary rock _____

